Affordable Superfoods for Pregnant and Breastfeeding Mothers

Ingredient	Nutrition (per 100 g)	Benefits for Pregnancy & Breastfeeding	Approximate Cost & Store	Cooking Difficulty
Chickpeas (cooked)	164 kcal, 8.9 g protein, 27.4 g carbohydrates, 7.6 g fiber, 2.6 mg iron, 49 mcg folate	Supports fetal brain development, increases iron intake, promotes digestive health	Walmart: Great Value dried chickpeas (1 lb) $1.50–$2.00; Aldi: Dakota's Pride canned chickpeas $0.89–$1.09 per can	Moderate (dried require soaking; canned are ready to use)
Lentils (cooked)	116 kcal, 9 g protein, 20 g carbohydrates, 8 g fiber, 3.3 mg iron, 181 mcg folate	Excellent source of folate and iron, supports healthy pregnancy and milk production	Walmart: Great Value Lentils (1 lb) $1.92; Aldi: Simply Nature lentils (1 lb) $1.89–$2.19	Very easy (20–25 minutes, no soaking required)
Blueberries	57 kcal, 0.7 g protein, 14.5 g carbohydrates, 2.4 g fiber	Rich in antioxidants, supports immune function and baby's brain development	Aldi: 16 oz $2.29; Walmart: 18 oz $5.12; Target: 11.2 oz $3.19	Ready to eat
Spinach	23 kcal, 2.9 g protein, 2.2 g fiber, 99 mg calcium, 2.7 mg iron	High in folate, iron, calcium, and vitamin K	Walmart: Fresh bunch $1.98; Aldi: Fresh spinach $1.79	Very easy

Eggs	143 kcal, 13 g protein, choline, vitamin D	Excellent source of choline for fetal brain development and high-quality protein	Walmart: Great Value eggs (dozen) $3.00–$5.00; Aldi: Goldhen eggs $3.00–$5.00	Very easy
Greek Yogurt	97 kcal, 10 g protein, calcium, probiotics	Supports bone health and gut health for mother and baby	Walmart: Great Value 32 oz $3.50–$4.00; Aldi: Friendly Farms 32 oz $3.50	Ready to eat
Sweet Potato	90 kcal, 2 g protein, 3.3 g fiber, vitamin A	Supports baby's vision, immune system, and healthy growth	Walmart: $1.10 per lb; Aldi: $0.99–$1.19 per lb	Easy
Oats	389 kcal, 16.9 g protein, 10.6 g fiber	High in fiber, iron, and may support breast milk production	Walmart: Great Value 42 oz $4.00; Aldi: Millville oats $3.00–$4.00	Very easy
Salmon (fresh or frozen)	208 kcal, 20 g protein, omega-3 fatty acids	Rich in DHA for baby's brain and eye development	Walmart: Frozen fillets $7.00–$10.00 per lb; Aldi: Fremont Fish Market $7.00–$9.00 per lb	Easy
Peanut Butter	588 kcal, 25 g protein, healthy fats	Provides energy, healthy fats, and plant-based protein	Walmart: Great Value 40 oz $5.00; Aldi: Creamy peanut butter $3.00–$4.00	Ready to eat

Avocado	160 kcal, healthy fats, folate, potassium	Supports fetal brain development and maternal heart health	Aldi: $0.79–$1.29 each; Walmart: $0.98–$1.50 each	Ready to eat
Brown Rice (cooked)	111 kcal, 2.6 g protein, 1.8 g fiber	Provides sustained energy and B vitamins	Walmart: Great Value 5 lb $5.00–$6.00; Aldi: Earthly Grains 5 lb $5.00–$6.00	Easy
Broccoli	34 kcal, 2.8 g protein, vitamin C, calcium	Boosts immunity and improves iron absorption	Walmart: About $2.00 per head; Aldi: About $1.99 per head	Very easy
Bananas	89 kcal, potassium, vitamin B6	Helps reduce muscle cramps and supports energy levels	Walmart: About $0.50 per lb; Aldi: About $0.33 per lb	Ready to eat
Chia Seeds	486 kcal, 17 g protein, 34 g fiber, omega-3 fatty acids	Excellent source of fiber, calcium, and healthy fats	Walmart: Great Value Organic Chia Seeds $5.00–$7.00 per bag	Ready to eat

Best Value Superfoods

Rank	Ingredient	Reason
1	Lentils	High in protein, iron, and folate while being one of the least expensive legumes.
2	Eggs	Affordable source of complete protein and choline.

3	Oats	Inexpensive, filling, rich in fiber and iron, and highly versatile.
4	Chickpeas	Affordable source of protein and fiber that can be used in many dishes.
5	Frozen Blueberries	Nutrient-dense, long shelf life, and rich in antioxidants.
6	Sweet Potatoes	Excellent source of vitamin A at a low cost.
7	Greek Yogurt	High in protein and calcium, suitable for meals and snacks.
8	Peanut Butter	Shelf-stable, affordable, and energy-dense with healthy fats and protein.